CANDIDATE CHECKLIST

5

questions to ask before you join a startup

Ask them before you sign. Save this for your next final round.

QUESTION 01

How long is your runway?

Ask in months, not "we're well funded". Then ask what happens if the next raise slips. Good founders have already planned for it.

QUESTION 02

Why is this role open now?

Either answer is fine. A vague one isn't.

A It's new: what changed to create it?

B It's a backfill: what happened last time?

QUESTION 03

90

days

What does success look like by then?

If nobody can describe it, the role isn't defined yet. That can be an opportunity, as long as you know it going in.

QUESTION 04

Who will I work with most?

Ask to meet them before you sign. The people beside you every day matter more than the pitch deck.

QUESTION 05

What is the equity really worth?

A percentage on its own tells you little. Ask for the detail in writing:

- Number of options
- Total shares
- Strike price
- Vesting and cliff
- Exercise window

SAVE THIS CHECKLIST

Ask all five before you sign.

Weighing up a startup offer and want a second opinion? DM us.

- Runway
- Why it's open
- 90-day success
- Your team
- Equity terms